GOURAV BHAGAT

HR & Talent Acquisition Professional | People Operations, Payroll & Full-Cycle Recruiting

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

HR and Talent Acquisition professional with 6+ years of experience across People Operations, full-cycle recruiting, and HR operations in startup environments scaling from 5 to 100+ employees. Experience spans HRMS implementation, payroll and compliance management, full employee lifecycle ownership, and technical recruiting including deep-tech and semiconductor hiring. Combines hands-on operational execution with team leadership of up to 8 direct reports, and a consistent focus on AI-assisted HR and recruiting workflows.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic HR & People Operations | Full-Cycle Talent Acquisition | HRMS Implementation | Payroll & Compliance Management | Employee Lifecycle Management | Team Leadership & Recruiter Management | Process & Workflow Optimization | Resource Mapping & P&L Analysis | Deep-Tech & Semiconductor Hiring | AI-Powered HR & Recruiting Tools

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HR Manager | Devkraft **Aug 2026 – Present**

IT-Services/Product Development Startup | India

- Owning the full recruitment lifecycle, from role intake and sourcing through screening, interview coordination, offer, and onboarding, working directly with hiring managers to keep candidates moving.
- Contributing to profit budgeting by bringing headcount and people-cost considerations into budget planning.
- Managing statutory and regulatory compliance across HR operations: maintaining employee records and documentation and keeping HR practices aligned with applicable requirements.
- Managing the full employee lifecycle, from onboarding and documentation through confirmation, ongoing employee support, and exit formalities.
- Processing monthly payroll and leave administration: consolidating attendance, leave, and salary inputs, validating them before disbursal, and keeping payouts accurate and on schedule.
- Driving process optimization across HR operations by identifying bottlenecks in recurring workflows and simplifying how they run.
- Coordinating with clients on workforce and HR-related requirements: understanding what they need, aligning internal teams to deliver it, and keeping them updated on hiring and people matters.
- Running the appraisal cycle: coordinating review inputs from managers and employees, tracking completion, and consolidating outcomes.
- Managing employee grievances end to end: receiving concerns, following up with the managers involved, documenting each case, and driving it to closure with fair, timely, and confidential outcomes.

Senior Technical Recruiter | MCGBS **Apr 2026 – Aug 2026**

Staffing Company | India

- Led end-to-end recruitment for semiconductor and IT roles across client requirements.
- Managed sourcing, screening, and candidate pipeline management for specialized technical positions in the semiconductor domain.
- Coordinated with clients to understand niche technical requirements and translated them into targeted sourcing strategies.

Senior HR Recruiter / Recruitment Lead | KoiReader Technologies **Sep 2024 – Mar 2026**

AI Startup (~100 employees) | Remote

- Led end-to-end hiring for 20+ specialized technical roles including Computer Vision, DevOps, Infrastructure, and Bare Metal Engineering, contributing to 50+ total hires with a 90%+ offer acceptance rate.
- Built and implemented AI-powered recruitment workflows that reduced screening time by 60% while maintaining high candidate quality standards.
- Designed structured interview frameworks and competency-based assessment models for niche technical roles, standardizing evaluation criteria across the entire tech team.
- Mentored 2 junior recruiters and 1 senior recruiter on advanced Boolean search, GitHub sourcing strategies, and niche talent mapping for specialized engineering roles.

- Partnered with engineering leadership to translate complex technical requirements into targeted sourcing strategies and employer branding initiatives.

HR Manager | Devkraft **Dec 2021 – Sep 2024**

IT-Services/Product Development Startup (20→70 employees) | India

- Collaborated with founders on strategic HR planning, team structuring, and organizational design initiatives during a 3x team growth phase.
- Implemented HRMS from scratch, improving process visibility, efficiency, and data management across the organization.
- Managed payroll coordination for a 60–70 person distributed team, processing monthly salary inputs, variable components, and tax proofs with zero compliance issues.
- Owned end-to-end HR operations, managing the full employee lifecycle from hiring to exit.
- Led and managed a team of up to 8 recruiters, overseeing daily operations, workload distribution, and performance.
- Acted as the first point of contact for employee and management queries, including those directed to the CTO, ensuring timely resolution and clear communication.
- Established a campus recruitment program across 6 Tier-1 engineering colleges and 7 Tier-1 business schools, building an early-career talent pipeline for technical and non-technical roles.
- Designed a structured onboarding program covering technical setup, policy orientation, and role-specific training for engineering and operations hires.
- Led vendor management, including complete office setup for Bangalore and Gurgaon locations.
- Drove resource mapping exercises to align team capacity with project demands and business growth plans.
- Contributed to P&L calculations by tracking recruitment costs, headcount planning, and resource utilization data.
- Managed end-to-end recruitment for technical roles, contributing to rapid team scaling during the 3x growth phase, using Boolean search, LinkedIn Recruiter, and GitHub sourcing strategies.
- Partnered with hiring managers to improve role clarity, refine job descriptions, and optimize hiring outcomes, ensuring strong candidate experience through streamlined communication and onboarding coordination.

HR – Talent Acquisition / Generalist | Devkraft **Dec 2019 – Dec 2021**

(5→20 employees)

- Supported payroll coordination by managing attendance records, leave inputs, and salary data for the growing team.
- Built structured talent pipelines and supported full-cycle recruitment across technical and non-technical roles during early-stage team scaling.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. – Health, Safety and Environment | NIFS India
Diploma – Health, Safety and Environment | NIFS India

CERTIFICATIONS — KEKA ACADEMY

- HR Generalist
- Core HR
- AI in HR
- Crafting Payroll in India
- Performance Management System

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

HRIS & ATS: Keka, Zoho Recruit, RMS
Sourcing Tools: LinkedIn Recruiter, GitHub, Naukri, Wellfound, Hirist, Boolean Search, X-Ray Search
AI & Automation: Claude, ChatGPT, Custom GPT Development, Workflow Automation
Analytics & Reporting: Google Sheets, Excel (Advanced), Recruitment Metrics
Collaboration Tools: Slack, Discord, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office Suite